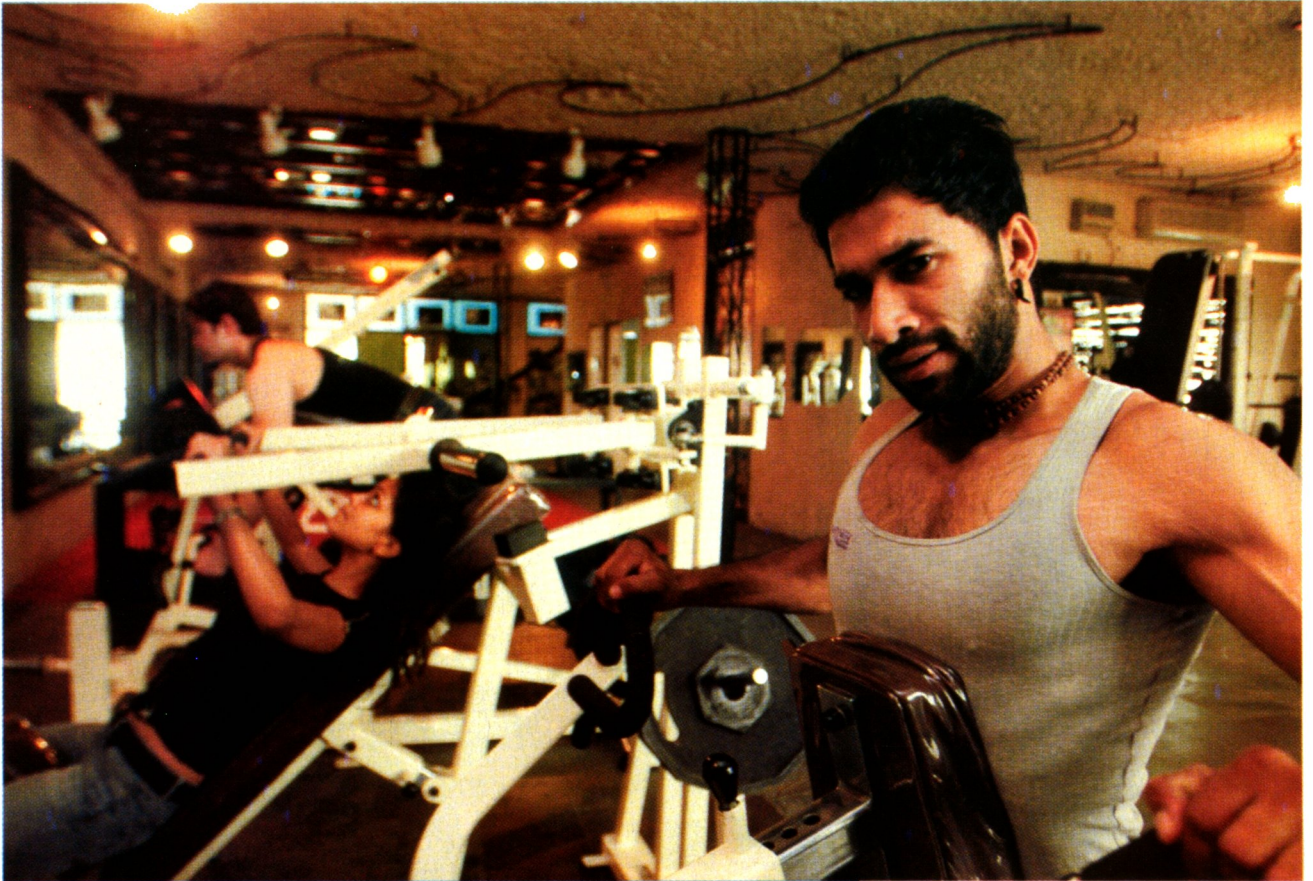




Workouts that Work

The new fitness mantras for the perfect body

4-5-6-6-5-4: Split workouts over three machines: spend four minutes running on the treadmill, then five minutes on the elliptical and six minutes on the stair machine. Repeat in reverse order.

PUSH AND PULL: Balance pushing and pulling exercises to give your body a full workout. If you're doing bench presses, for instance, make time for pull-ups too.

ROUNDHOUSE KICKS: For the lower back, lower abs and coordination. Stand straight with a chair at your right side. Hold on to the chair as you lift your left leg so it's parallel to the floor. Rotate body, leading with belly button, and kick across the plane.

ACTIVE STRETCHING: Jog around the gym, followed by active stretching. Instead of sitting down and pushing or pulling on your muscles, which can cause injury and reduce your muscles' power output, try doing 10 high kicks, high steps or split squats.

50 PUSH-UPS A DAY: If you really want to change your body, try doing 50 push-ups a day. The key is to do them correctly, pushing up from your chest, not your shoulders. Also, be careful not to bow your back. Spend five seconds on the way down and another five on the way up, keeping your stomach tight.

on sidewalks, in beauty parlours, outside multiplexes, in men's desires and their own dreams.

Having a male body is much like having a bank account, wrote novelist John Updike. As long as it's healthy, you don't think much about it. Clearly Updike never met Shah Rukh Khan. Nor would he recognise this particular moment in the biography of masculinity where looking good can be counter-intuitive. Today's buff-and-ready man stands squarely at the intersection of beauty, vanity and health. But in forging new standards for himself, he has opened up a Pandora's box: will unrealistic images lead to greater body image dissatisfaction, mental health issues, and threats to healthy physical functioning? Will men remember to enjoy the body they have in their drive for the perfect abs? The jury is still out on that but for now, SRK reigns—absolutely.

with Kimi Dangor, Akhila Kirshnamurthy, Nandini Vaish, Swagata Sen, Ramesh Vinayak, Uday Mahurkar and Stephen David